

Choosing the Right Tool

Matching Technology to Problem

Every technology decision is a bet. You're betting that a tool will solve your problem better than the alternatives—and that the costs (learning curve, constraints, dependencies) are worth it.

Questions to Ask

What problem does it solve? If you can't articulate this clearly, you're probably adopting technology for the wrong reasons.

Do I have that problem? Kubernetes solves orchestration at scale. If you have three servers, you probably don't need it.

What's the learning curve? A powerful tool you can't use effectively isn't powerful at all.

What's the community like? Active communities mean more resources, faster bug fixes, and continued development. Abandoned projects become liabilities.

What are the escape hatches? Can you drop down to lower levels when needed? Can you migrate away if the tool doesn't work out?

Red Flags

- Choosing technology because it's trendy
- Adopting tools to pad your resume
- Over-engineering for problems you don't have
- Ignoring the boring, proven option

The Boring Technology Rule

Dan McKinley's "Choose Boring Technology" argues that every team has a limited budget for complexity. Spend it on your actual business problems, not on exciting new databases.

PostgreSQL, Linux, and Python aren't exciting. They're also incredibly reliable, well-documented, and understood by most developers. Sometimes boring is exactly right.

When to Adopt New Technology

New tools earn their place when:

- They solve a problem you genuinely have
- The benefits clearly outweigh the learning and integration costs
- You have time to learn them properly
- You've evaluated alternatives

Otherwise, stick with what you know.